Intermediate

08 Alternating Reels

09 Alternating Reels Turns

10 Orbitals

11 Extended Reel

12 Thread the Needle

12b Take-Outs

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info

Lesson 8
Intermediate: Alternating Reels (page 1 of 1)

Alternating reels not only look wicked, but are great for helping you move your hands independly of each other. When we say alternating a move, both of your hands do the same sequence but one is always a beat behind the other. With alternating reels, your hands do reels in opposite directions with one poi in front of you and the other poi behind you.

Alternating Reels

1.

To start this move spin 'outward' hip reels. You'll probably find it easier to start spinning one poi first and when its behind you start the other in front of you.

2.

Swap hands on the next beat of the poi so that your left hand is now in front and your right is behind.

Continue to turn a further 90º until you're facing the opposite direction. Woo Hoo! You should now have turned 180º degrees and be spinning backward circles.

Inwards Alternating Reels

There are other reels that you can alternate. Try alternating inwards hip reels. Remember - one hand should always be in front when the other is behind.

Alternating Shoulder Reels

You can also try alternating shoulder reels - inwards and outwards. This move uses the same principal as the other alternating reels.

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info

Lesson 9
Intermediate: Alternating Reels Turns (page 1 of 1)

There are many different variations of alternating reel turns. We're going to look at one basic sequence which you can play around with and develop to create the countless others available.

The main aim to a good reel turn is being able to turn 180 or even 360 in one beat of the poi. Being able to do this improves your overall ability to turn as well as helping you to invent turns on the spot.

Alternating Reels Turns

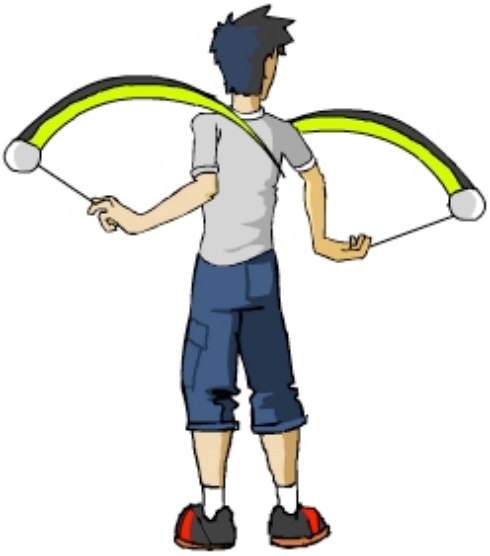
1.

Our starting point for this move is an inwards alternating reel. When the right poi is in front of you turn to your right...

2.

...Continue turning as the poi come up...

3.



You should now have turned 180 with your poi landing in an outward alternating reel.

Developing Turns

There are many different turn combinations to choose from. Every time you do an alternating reel turn you're in charge of which hand is in front when you start the turn and subsequently which hand ends up in front when you finish. You can also choose whether you go left or right and not forgetting whether you start with inwards or outwards alternating reels.

When you've done all these you can then double the amount by doing the same again with alternating shoulder reels, giving you plenty of freedom and variation in your displays. All you have to remember is to start your turns as the poi come up, and finish by the time the poi have landed at the bottom.

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info

Lesson 10
Intermediate: Orbitals (page 1 of 1)

The Sweep is a nice variation of Alternating Shoulder Reels. The basic principle is the same except you spin big circles in front of you instead of small ones.

Start with outwards Alternating Shoulder Reels, and start to make the circles in front bigger and bigger - remember though, that the circles behind stay small.

Orbitals

1.

Get yourself into a rhythm with Alternating Shoulder Reels. As one poi comes up and over your head from behind, reach your arm out and around...

2.

...Draw a big circle in front of your body.

3.

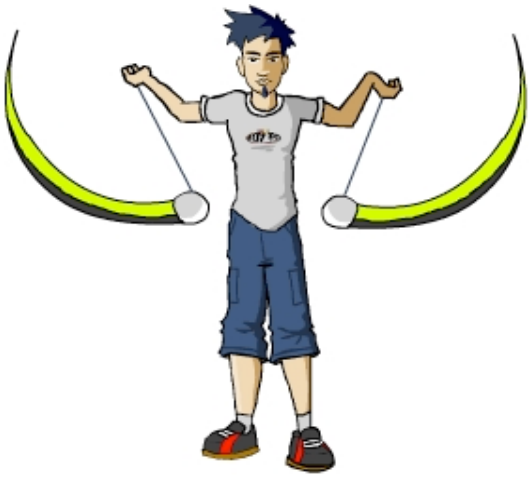
As the poi comes up lift it over your head and let it follow its natural path behind you and draw a small circle as your other hand is drawing a large circle in front.

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info

Lesson 11
Intermediate: Extended Reel (page 1 of 1)

Extended Reels are basically what they sound like - They are an extension of the Reel. In this sequence both poi do a circle behind the shoulder, a circle behind your hips, and then finish with a circle in front of your shoulder.

1.



From spinning circles in front of you, carry both poi up to your shoulders and let them fall behind you.

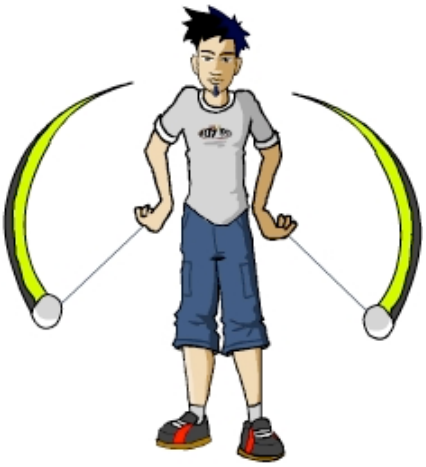
2.

..Push your palms outwards to bring the poi down to hip level.

3.

...And let spin a hip circle behind you.

4.



As the poi come down, direct them in front of you ready to start again (step1).

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info

Lesson 12
Intermediate: Thread the Needle (page 1 of 2)

This is a great move to learn and when done well even better to watch. It's based around the butterfly, so make sure you're brushed up on that and are able to do it with either hand on top. This is important as you push your hands forwards and back, swapping the top hand on every beat.

1.

Ok, start with some inwards butterfly keeping your right hand on top.

2.

As the poi come up swap so that your left hand is now on top...

3.

Keep on practicing this until you are comfortable swapping hands on every beat.

4.

Ok, continue to swap your top hand on every beat, but now try pushing your hands forwards a bit as they land on top, and pull the other one back a bit.
Turn over for step 5…

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info

Lesson 12
Intermediate: Thread the Needle (page 2 of 2)

5.

When you're comfortable doing this, all that's left to do is exaggerate the movement. Punch your top hand forwards as the poi lands on top and pull your lower hand to your arm pit.

To get the best effect, slide your hand along your arm. This way both circles share the same centre point.

Lesson 12b
Intermediate: Take-outs

Once you're comfortable with the Butterfly and Threading the Needle you can develop this with Take-outs.

From a Butterfly or Thread the Needle, take one hand out and let it spin a circle else where for one beat and then bring it back.

You can do this with both hands either from the top or bottom of the Butterfly. The hand that is not doing the Take-out stays in the same place and continues to spin a Butterfly. This takes more concentration than you think so stay patient.

Copyright © 2005 Flamin' Funky Fire Monkey Ltd.
http://www.poipoi.info